

between channels like cable, but entirely free. It's ad-supported, but the interruptions are no worse than what you'd expect from regular television.

Pluto TV curates "pop-up" channels around trends – like Oscar season, holiday classics, or 90s nostalgia – that rotate monthly, keeping the lineup fresh and seasonal.

2. Tubi

Platforms: Android, iOS

A massive catalog of free movies and TV – including hidden gems you've never seen. Tubi is what happens when Netflix and a bargain bin DVD store have a clever, ad-supported baby. It hosts over 50,000 titles spanning every genre: from cult horror to indie dramas, from Bollywood to anime. There's even a surprising amount of old but beloved Hollywood fare – think *The Matrix Reloaded*, *Legally Blonde*, or *The Karate Kid* – rotating in and out of its free library.



The app doesn't ask for sign-ups or subscriptions (though making an account lets you save watchlists). Playback is smooth, and the ad breaks are tolerable. You can binge for hours without paying a cent. Tubi's "Not on Netflix" section highlights movies and shows exclusive to its platform – perfect for discovering titles that somehow fell through the streaming cracks.

3. Crunchyroll (Free Tier)

Platforms: Android, iOS

Stream anime legally, free, and in HD. If you love anime or are curious to explore it, Crunchyroll is your gateway. While the paid tier removes ads and unlocks simulcasts faster, the free tier still offers hundreds of series – from long-runners like *Naruto* and *Attack on Titan* to quirky modern hits like *Spy x Family* and *Chainsaw Man*. Episodes stream in 720p or higher, and subtitles are crisp and accurate.

The community around Crunchyroll is huge, and new users can dive straight into curated collections (e.g., "Fantasy Worlds," "New to Anime," "Must-See Classics").

Crunchyroll's Manga Portal offers selected free digital manga chapters directly inside the app – perfect for readers who want to go beyond the screen.

4. Libby

Platforms: Android, iOS

A free library card in app form – books, audiobooks, and magazines galore. Imagine borrowing thousands of bestsellers and audiobooks without ever setting foot in a library. That's Libby, a beautifully designed app by OverDrive that connects to your local public library system. All you need is a valid library card, and you can instantly borrow ebooks, audiobooks, comics, and magazines – no fees, no returns late.

The interface is stunningly simple: browse shelves by genre or recommendation, download offline, and even send books directly to your Kindle (where supported). It's one of the few apps that feels like a genuine public good in the digital age.

Libby supports *multiple library cards*, letting avid readers borrow from different libraries at once – a secret power for those who travel or have memberships in multiple regions.

5. Pocket Casts

Platforms: Android, iOS

A sleek, professional-grade podcast app that's now 100% free. Pocket Casts used to be a paid favorite of hardcore podcast listeners – until it went free in 2023. The app is adored for its minimal interface and power features: silence trimming, volume boost, variable playback speed, and seamless syncing between devices.

You can discover new shows via charts and curated categories, or import your favorites manually. Playback is clean and reliable, with plenty of customization – a rare balance between simplicity and control. It's one of the best examples of a paid-quality app turned free without compromise.

The "Up Next" queue lets you build your own radio-style playlist that automatically plays episode after episode across multiple shows.



6. Tunity

Platforms: Android, iOS

Listen to muted TVs anywhere – in real-time, synced perfectly. Tunity is one of those "how is this even possible?" apps that feels like sorcery. Point your phone's camera at a muted television – in a gym, airport, restaurant, or bar – and Tunity identifies the channel and streams the live audio feed directly to your phone. Pop in your headphones, and suddenly the silent screen comes alive.

It's especially useful for sports fans, travelers, or anyone tired of missing commentary in public places. The magic lies in its